



STATUS REPORT

Somalia: status report

Edition of 2026-08-16 · 51 systems and instruments tracked, 10 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-14 from the Data Landscapers source base, from [outputs/reports/SOM/ledger.csv](#) (51 systems and instruments, 10 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

Somalia is building foundational digital systems from a base of almost nothing, and building them fast. The national identity credential, issued since September 2023, reached [about 2m registrations by April 2026 against a target of 15m by the end of 2029](#), in a country where [about 85% of an estimated 19.7m people held no legal identity](#).

Payments run the other way round: a private mobile-money system reaching most of the population, into which the state is now inserting a rail — the [instant payment system, live since January 2025](#), whose mobile-money integration has no published date.

The legal stack is unusually complete for a fragile state. A data-protection Act has been in force since March 2023, its [regulatory framework was adopted in February 2026](#), and a [Cybersecurity Law was approved in January 2026](#).

The unsettled questions are political rather than technical: two member states decline the federal credential, and the compulsory use imposed on it rests on a proclamation that a published legal analysis says the Act does not authorise.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Starlink satellite service	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Available nationwide from August 2025, four months after licensing
Submarine cable landings and their regulatory framework	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	First submarine cable landing technical working group opened with the IFC, June 2026

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Government data-hosting and cloud guidelines	PLANNED ↗	Still at its November 2022 baseline against an April 2028 target
Hormuud data centre estate	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Operator reported as investing in further solar-powered domestic capacity
National Data Centre, Mogadishu	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Reported nearing completion at a ministerial inspection, 6 May 2025

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National IPv6 migration	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Migration accelerated by the regulator and a National IPv6 Centre

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National Cybersecurity Risk Management Framework	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched 21 July 2026, after a national consultation in April
Somalia Computer Incident Response Team (SOMCIRT)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Opened by the Prime Minister, 7 March 2026

Starlink was licensed in April 2025 and [available across the country by August, at US\\$390 for hardware and US\\$70 a month](#), on a full foreign-ownership model accepted without major public debate. Internet users were put at [10.7m, more than half the population](#), with median fixed download at [18.76 Mbps](#) and mobile data at about [US\\$0.50 per GB](#) in October 2025.

The cables that carry the rest have no regulatory framework. Landings exist at Mogadishu, Berbera and Bosaso, and the regulator [opened a first technical working group with the IFC in June 2026](#) on outage management, competition and a framework that is not yet published. Address capacity is being extended through a [national IPv6 migration run with a centre at Jamhuriya University](#), with no adoption percentage published.

Hosting is private. Hormuud [runs the country's working hosting base and states it is investing in further domestic capacity](#). The state's own National Data Centre was [described as nearing completion in May 2025](#) and no launch is recorded since; the ministry's stated purpose for it — ending reliance on storage outside the country — is also its statement that government data was held offshore when it spoke. No government data-hosting or cloud guidelines are published: the World Bank's seventh implementation report on the regional digital-integration project records the indicator [still at its November 2022 baseline against an April 2028 target](#).

Cyber institutions were built within eighteen months. The [incident response team opened on 7 March 2026 with 45 officials in first-phase training](#), and a [national risk management framework was launched on 21 July 2026](#) with no compliance deadline or reporting duty attached.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Interoperability between government systems	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Named as the central risk in a domestic analysis and in the DPI summit communique, April 2026

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Compulsory use of the national identity credential	IMPLEMENTED, CONTESTED ↗	Enforced at Aden Adde airport for inter-state travel from March 2026
eAqoonsi mobile identity application	IMPLEMENTED ↗	More than 50,000 downloads reported, April 2026
HUBIYE consent-based verification platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched with the certificate delivery system and the mobile identity application
Member state participation in the national identity system	IMPLEMENTED, NOT ADOPTED IN TWO MEMBER STATES ↗	Puntland operating its own identification authority
National passport	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Cabinet approved a third-generation e-passport plan, 6 August 2026
Somali National Identity credential (SNID)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	About 2m registered by April 2026

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
EVC Plus mobile money	IMPLEMENTED ↗	GSMA Mobile Money re-certified, August 2025
Somalia Instant Payment System (SIPS)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Central Bank set out the integration sequence, 26 July 2026
SOMQR national QR payment standard	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Linked to the instant payment system as the national standard

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Unified digital civil registration system	PILOTING ↗	Unified system documented on OpenCRVS, January 2026

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Electronic Immunization Register	PILOTING ↗	Piloted in 14 Banadir facilities with scaling to more than 80 planned

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digital voter registration	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Equipment unveiled by the electoral commission, March 2025
National job portal	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched as a centralised, domestically hosted platform
National Single Window	PLANNED ↗	Named as planned within the HoA DRIVE Somalia project, 3 August 2026

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Rural digital data capture	NOT HELD	—

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
SUMER revenue collection terminals (Hirshabelle)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Tariff-loaded terminals deployed at state border checkpoints

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Earth observation or geospatial data programme	NOT HELD	—

Identity is the spine and the fault line. The credential is issued in three forms — card, mobile application and printable certificate — verified through a consent-based platform built in-house, and is now required for passports, bank accounts, driving licences, vehicle registration and domestic travel, enforced for inter-state travel from March 2026. Two things about that are unsettled and both are on the record. Puntland and Jubbaland decline to implement it, Puntland running its own identification authority and citing data control, election influence and regional autonomy. And a published legal analysis holds that the proclamation making use of the credential compulsory exceeds the Act, which confers a right to an identity and imposes no duty to obtain one. The two accounts have not been reconciled. Where the identity data is physically held is a separate open question the base does not settle.

Take-up of the digital form lags the register: more than 50,000 downloads of the mobile identity against about 2m registrations, with digital activation still requiring an in-person visit. Beneath it, civil registration is piloted across 19 districts on an open-source platform; above it, the passport is being replaced, with the East African Community e-passport cleared in February 2026 and a third-generation plan approved by Cabinet on 6 August 2026.

Payments are where the state is the newcomer. The instant payment system carries person-to-person, merchant and both directions of government payment on ISO 20022, targeting 14 banks and eight wallet providers, and is operated by a joint venture of the Central Bank and 13 commercial banks. The rail it is joining is EVC Plus, GSMA re-certified in August 2025 and serving 4.5m daily users.

Service platforms are arriving one at a time: a domestically hosted national job portal, an immunization register in 14 Banadir facilities against about 60% of children recorded as zero-dose, and at state level tariff-loaded revenue terminals in Hirshabelle. What connects them is not established: a domestic analysis names fragmentation and weak coordination as the central risk, and no interoperability standard is published.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Cybersecurity Law	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Approved by Parliament, 26 January 2026

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digital Transformation Strategy 2025-2030	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Finalisation under way with ITU support, October 2025

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Connection to the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System	PLANNED ↗	Stated by the Central Bank as a target for before the end of 2026

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Data Protection Act (Law 005/2023)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In effect since 23 March 2023, with implementing regulations reviewed
Data Protection Authority	IMPLEMENTED ↗	First nationwide enforcement step: mandatory registration under Article 32, June 2026
Regulatory framework for the public data protection law	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Approved by the Council of Ministers on 8 January 2026 and adopted the following month
Request to delay WhatsApp usernames	PLANNED ↗	Request made in a regulator statement of 6 July 2026 and restated by the minister on 22 July

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Public debate on digital policy	NOT HELD	—

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
European Union digital cooperation with Somalia	NOT HELD	—

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Open government data	NOT HELD	—

The statute book is ahead of the systems it governs, which is unusual. The [Data Protection Act has been in force since March 2023](#), carrying data-subject rights and fines of 2 to 4% of worldwide turnover, though it does not define public data, which clouds the regulator's mandate. Its [regulatory framework was approved by the Council of Ministers on 8 January 2026](#), and the Authority took its [first nationwide enforcement step in June 2026](#), requiring all [controllers and processors to register](#) and issuing compliance certificates. No penalty has been issued on the record, and the Authority's independence is qualified by executive appointment and override powers.

The [Cybersecurity Law approved on 26 January 2026](#) assigns policy to the communications ministry, technical oversight to the regulator and obligations to critical-infrastructure operators, and creates the incident response team that opened six weeks later.

Policy is the piece still open. The [Digital Transformation Strategy 2025-2030 is being finalised with ITU support](#) and no adopted text is published.

One regulatory position is aimed outward. The regulator has [asked Meta to delay the rollout of WhatsApp usernames](#), citing impersonation risk to the mobile-money system and the loss of phone-number traceability; no platform response is on record. Regionally, the Central Bank names a [connection to the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System as a target for before end-2026](#) rather than a concluded arrangement.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Somali National University AI Centre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched by the university, July 2026
National artificial intelligence policy	NOT HELD	—

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National e-commerce strategy	PLANNED ↗	Still at its November 2022 baseline against an April 2028 target

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National startup network	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Unveiled at the innovation forum in Mogadishu, 22 July 2026
Regulator partnership with iRise Hub	PLANNED ↗	Memorandum signed, 30 July 2026

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Chinese digital cooperation with Somalia	NOT HELD	—

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Indian digital cooperation with Somalia	NOT HELD	—

The Somali National University [launched an AI centre in July 2026 for research and digital skills](#), with no funding, staffing or research output stated. The base holds no national AI strategy, ministerial mandate or government position. No national e-commerce strategy exists in Somalia, South Sudan or the IGAD region, on the [World Bank's June 2026 report](#) against an April 2028 target.

The innovation layer is donor-built and new. A [national startup network was launched on 22 July 2026 on European Union funding implemented by UNIDO](#), the project reporting 3,600 applications across three cohorts and more than 200 startups incubated; the same account states intellectual-property legislation is being developed, with no bill or timeline on file. The telecoms regulator has [signed a memorandum with a private innovation hub covering skills, cybersecurity and research](#) that carries no figure, term, named deliverable or funder.

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Smartphone financing programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched by Hormuud with Get-Phone, May 2026

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digital literacy programmes	NOT HELD	—

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Certified cybersecurity training for government ICT staff	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Internationally certified courses run in Mogadishu and Nairobi, March to May 2026
Fixed asset management training (Somaliland administration)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Training launched, 4 August 2026

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
University research partnership on official microdata	PILOTING ↗	Three-day technical workshop closed with three partner universities, July 2026

The access constraint named by the operators is the handset rather than the network. A [financing programme launched in May 2026 targets 100,000 affordable smartphones by the end of the year, at a US\\$19 deposit and US\\$0.60 to US\\$1.60 a day repaid over mobile money](#), scored on SIM tenure and spending rather than credit history, with a pilot recording under 4% default.

Capacity work is thin and mostly donor-run. Government ICT staff took [internationally certified cybersecurity courses in Mogadishu and Nairobi between March and May 2026](#) on World Bank funding, and the statistics bureau ran a [pilot training researchers from three universities on its household budget and labour force microdata](#) on Swiss funding with no amount stated — which puts the constraint on evidence-based policy at analytical capacity rather than at data collection.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project, Somalia component	IMPLEMENTED, UNDER IMPLEMENTATION ↗	Seventh implementation report; a mid-term review held January to April 2026 raised the development-objective rating from Moderately Unsatisfactory to Moderately Satisfactory
World Bank financing for the digital identity rollout	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Officials put the remaining cost of completing the rollout at about US\$125m, January 2026

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Domestic budget appropriations for the digital sector	NOT HELD	—

The identity rollout is externally financed and short of money. Digital identity is [a pillar of the World Bank-funded SPRING initiative of more than US\\$100m](#), and officials put the remaining cost of completing it at [about US\\$125m in January 2026](#), with no funding source named. US\$10m of Somalia's allocation under the Eastern Africa Regional Digital Integration Project was [cancelled in April 2026](#), and private-sector investment mobilised under it stands at US\$0 against a US\$10m target. No domestic appropriation for the sector is held.

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National artificial intelligence policy	An adopted or draft national AI strategy, a ministerial mandate, or a government statement setting an AI position.	not yet probed
Earth observation or geospatial data programme	A national geospatial or earth-observation programme document, or an agency mandate covering satellite data.	not yet probed
Rural digital data capture	A pastoralist, agricultural or rural registry, or a field data-collection programme covering rural populations.	not yet probed
Public debate on digital policy	Published civil-society analysis, a parliamentary debate record, or a consultation response on a digital instrument.	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Open government data	An open-data portal, a published dataset release policy, or an agency statement on publishing government data.	not yet probed
Digital literacy programmes	A national digital literacy curriculum, campaign or programme document.	not yet probed
Domestic budget appropriations for the digital sector	The federal appropriation act or budget statement showing the votes for the communications ministry, the regulator and the identity authority.	not yet probed
European Union digital cooperation with Somalia	A Global Gateway or EU delegation announcement, a financing agreement, or a programme document naming Somalia beyond the innovation project already held.	not yet probed
Chinese digital cooperation with Somalia	A bilateral agreement, vendor contract or financing arrangement naming Somalia.	not yet probed
Indian digital cooperation with Somalia	A bilateral memorandum, a line-of-credit agreement, or an India Stack or ITEC programme document naming Somalia.	not yet probed

Ten rows carry no reliable statement of position. Nine are subjects the base holds nothing on for Somalia: earth-observation and geospatial programmes, rural data capture, open government data, digital literacy, public debate on digital policy, domestic appropriations, and European Union, Chinese and Indian cooperation. The tenth is a national artificial intelligence policy, which the base does not show to exist in any form. Separately, where the national identity data is physically held is a disagreement rather than an absence, and is carried in the wiki's contradictions queue.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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